

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 37)

- #9-11: 1 point for each correct element (separated by +) (max 11)
 - order of phrases does not matter, order within phrases DOES matter
- #16-18: (max 26)
 - 1 point for each correct English sentence element (max 12)
 - 1 point for each correct highlighting (max 3)
 - 1 point for each correct Paiwan sentence element (max 11)
 - insist on complete correctness within each element, e.g. no extra incorrect words (e.g. *who are ...*) and correct function (e.g. re subject/object)
 - accept minor errors unrelated to the data, e.g. *on* for *in*, or *protects* for *protect*, *a~the*, *is eating* for *eats*
 - No marks for focus if more than one element is underlined
 - Credit underlined elements even if the element itself is wrong (e.g. has the wrong function).

9	Paiwan	sitarang + nua uqatay + tua quma + a watu (4)
10	Paiwan	qatupan + nua supulingaw + tua kuqaya-qayam + a gadu nua tsemas (4)
11	Paiwan	djmavis + tua vavuy + a vavaian (3)
16	English	You + protect + the shaman's bird + with <u>the spirit</u> . (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	anema + a kusitarang + tua qaya-qayam + nua pulingaw? (4) OR anema + a kusitarang + nua pulingaw + tua qaya-qayam?
17	English	The man + eats + <u>the pig</u> + in the mountain. (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	anema + a kanen + nua uqatay + i tua gadu? (4) OR anema + a kanen + i tua gadu + nua uqatay?
18	English	I + hunt + your dog + in <u>my field</u> . (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	inu + a suqatupan + tua kuvatu? (3)

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020
Round 2



Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Commentary

Paiwan has 4 types of focus in a sentence: Agent Focus (AF), Patient Focus (PF), Referent Focus (RF) and Instrument Focus (IF). Depending on which element of a sentence is focused, the verb conjugates differently.

Agent – subject of transitive verb

Patient – object of transitive verb

Referent – location/time/beneficiary of action

Instrument – instrument/cause/motivation of action

The affixes are:

AF: **-m-** after initial consonant

PF: **-en**

RF: **-an**

IF: **si-**

The article of the noun phrase changes depending on whether it is focused or not:

a = focused element/equational construction marker (CM=)

tua = unfocused non-agent

nua = unfocused agent/genitive construction marker (CMgen)

CM= means that two elements are equal to each other or describe each other.

Another way that you could look at these constructions is that the verbal affixes are derivational morphemes that change the verb into a noun, i.e. **kan** = eat, **k-m-an** = the one who eats, **si-kan** = the thing with which one eats. In this instance, the agent becomes the ‘possessor’ of the new noun and so goes into the genitive case (**nua**).

Both these explanations describe the same data and either would lead to a correct interpretation.

Finally, there are also the prefixes **ku-** and **su-** which refer to the 1st and 2nd person singular respectively. When attached to nouns they indicate possession, and to verbs they indicate agency (although with the derivational theory, the verbs have become nouns anyway).